



THERE IS NOTHING IMPOSSIBLE TO HE WHO WILL TRY

THE CONQUESTS OF ALEXANDER THE GREAT (4TH CENTURY BCE)

IN CONTEXT

FOCUS

Hellenistic world

BEFORE

359 BCE Philip II of Macedonia begins his rise to power and develops innovative military technology and tactics.

338 BCE Philip II defeats the Greek states and becomes undisputed leader of Greece.

336 BCE On Philip's death, his son Alexander is proclaimed king of Macedonia.

AFTER

321 BCE After Alexander's death, squabbling between his generals breaks out into widespread civil war.

278 BCE Alexander's generals establish three Hellenistic kingdoms in Greece, the Middle East, and Europe.

30 BCE The Roman emperor Octavian annexes Egypt, the last Hellenistic kingdom.

In one of the fastest and most daring military expansions in history, Alexander the Great, the young king of Macedonia in the Balkans, blazed a trail of conquest across most of the known world of his day, and set in motion a process of Hellenization—the spread of Greek culture

East–West **cultural exchange** begins from an era of **Persian Wars**, with western provinces of Persian Empire becoming **Hellenized** and Macedonians adopting aspects of **Persian culture**.



Alexander's conquests force the rapid synthesis of Greek and Asian cultures, laying seeds of the Hellenistic age.



Hellenized societies in Egypt and West Asia **assimilated** into Roman Empire.



Hellenistic learning survives the fall of Rome in the **Byzantine Empire** and in the **Translation Movement** of the **Islamic Caliphate**.

and its fusion with non-Greek, Eastern traditions—which endured for centuries.

Alexander's father, Philip II, had transformed this peripheral state into a formidable military power, and had waged campaigns against his neighbors that culminated in Macedonia's domination over all of Greece. When he was assassinated in 336 BCE, Philip had been planning an expedition to West Asia, to